



GDD 42

Life Ready

Ready for the life ahead

The life-skills game for the threshold of adulthood (ages 15-18), the penultimate lesson before the Decoded finale. It carries the feelings thread's emotional intelligence into near-adult life: knowing yourself and your values, deciding well, handling the big transitions and stresses (board exams, leaving home, failure, uncertainty), working with people, and building a support network you can lean on, for good. It consolidates the Life-Skills Toolkit a player has built since age three. Seven mechanics, 29 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Ready for the life ahead.

Life Ready completes the feelings-and-life-skills thread by carrying its emotional-intelligence work into the demands of near-adult life: knowing yourself and your values, making mature decisions, handling the big transitions and stresses (board exams, leaving home, uncertainty, failure), working well with people, and building a support network you can rely on long after school. It is the grown-up of the thread that began with Feelings Friends and ran through Heart Smart, Mind Matters and Bounce, putting the whole skill set to work on the real choices and changes of becoming an adult, and consolidating the app's persistent Life-Skills Toolkit into something a young person carries out of the app and into their life. New v2 build.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g42 · life-ready (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 5 · ages 15-18 · mature / motivating / grounded
Thread / topics	C · Feelings & Life Skills · UNESCO 5.2, 5.6, 5.1, 5.5
Prerequisite / builds on	g35 (Justice League) · builds on g39 (Bounce) · draws on g16 · precedes g36
Gating	Core · penultimate Chapter 5 lesson
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the adult life-skills game.

85

scenarios

7

mechanics

12

myth-flips

29

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

The adult toolkit: know yourself, decide well, don't go it alone. Good adult decisions start with self-knowledge and run on a learnable method (facts, values, consequences, the long game, then own it). Big transitions are met with healthy strategies only, never minimised. And the thread's most important message: you don't have to do adulthood alone, help-seeking is a lifelong strength, not a failure, and a support network is something you keep for life.

On the edge of running their own life.

From the Chapter 5 personas (15-18). Near-adults facing board exams, leaving home, career and relationship choices, and growing independence, with everything the curriculum has built now needing to work in the real world.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Every teen	To know their values and decide by them, on purpose.	reflect + branch : know yourself, decide.
Arjun, 17	To handle board-exam pressure with healthy strategies.	branch + strike-rewrite : handle the big stuff.
Sneha, 17	People skills, communication, boundaries, conflict.	role-play + sort : people skills.
The Counsellor	To normalise help-seeking and route distress to support.	match + branch : your support network.

Why this works (the evidence). Good decisions start with self-knowledge (values, strengths, emotional self-awareness), and mature decision-making is a learnable method. Late adolescence brings big, real transitions and stress, in India around 81% of students cite schoolwork and exams as a source of anxiety, met with healthy strategies only (name it, break it down, lean on people, ask early), never pain or self-destructive coping. Half of adult life is other people, and the most important message is that you don't have to do adulthood alone: help-seeking continues for life and is a strength, with real support a call away (Tele-MANAS 14416, KIRAN, Manodarpan).

Seven moves, led by the choice and the reflection.

It's a life-skills game, so **branch** leads (real decisions, transitions and people-situations), with **reflect** mapping the player's own values and **strike-rewrite** clearing the life-myths. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE YOUNG PERSON DOES	EMBODIES	N
branch (decide & handle) signature	Decides, navigates a transition, or handles a people-situation.	Life in action.	24
reflect	Maps their values, strengths and the toolkit they now carry.	Self-knowledge.	26
strike-rewrite	Busts a life-myth ("asking for help means you've failed").	Conceptual change.	12
sort	Sorts healthy vs harmful coping; strengthens vs strains.	The line.	10
match	Pairs a decision step, or a support type, to what it does.	Connections.	6
role-play (voice)	Communicates, sets a boundary, reaches out for support.	Voice; people skills.	5
spot	Spots the healthy response, or the pressure in a decision.	Reading the room.	2

29 of 85 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

Game feel is mature, motivating and grounded, closer to a respected personal-development tool than a teen app. The life-sim's branching futures make adult choices and their consequences visible; there's a satisfying "toolkit assembled" payoff as self-knowledge, decisions, people-skills and support come together; and honest, near-adult scenarios feel real and respectful. Sam appears grown too, a quiet bookend to the small friend who began the journey in Feelings Friends.

Is it teaching?

Yes: articulating your own values and strengths; making mature, values-based decisions; handling major transitions and stress with healthy strategies and resilience; communicating, collaborating, setting boundaries and resolving conflict; and building and using a support network, knowing help-seeking continues into adulthood. It is honest that adulthood brings hard moments, and equips a young person to meet them.

The belief it moves. From "you should have it all figured out; there's one right path; failing makes you a failure; asking for help means you've failed at adulting" → "self-knowledge unfolds for life; decide well by your own values; failure is an event to learn from; and help-seeking is a lifelong strength."

Built, not bolted on.

85 researched scenarios across the know-yourself → decide → handle-the-big-stuff → people-skills → support-network → toolkit arc, evidence-based and India-grounded. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Know yourself	14	reflect, sort, branch	Values, strengths, emotional self-awareness; no 'right' values.
Decide like an adult	15	branch, sort, strike-rewrite	The method; no single right path; resist pressure, own it.
Handle the big stuff	17	branch, strike-rewrite, sort	Exams, leaving home, failure; healthy coping; route distress.
People skills	15	role-play, branch, sort	Communication, boundaries, conflict, collaboration.
Your support network	13	match, branch, strike-rewrite	Build it; help-seeking is lifelong; route to real help.
The Life-Ready toolkit	11	reflect, match, sort	The assembled toolkit; equipped, and not alone.

The 'asking for help' flip + a decision branch, verbatim.

```
flip: "Asking for help means you've failed at being an adult."
UN -> "Asking for help means you've failed at adulting."
RE -> "Help-seeking is a lifelong strength; capable adults lean on people too."

branch: "You face a big decision about study or your future."
best -> "Gather facts, weigh your values and the long term, then choose and own it"
```

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 42 Life Ready — Scenario Library.json](#) (85 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
By now you should have it all figured out.	Self-knowledge unfolds for life; you only need to start, not finish.	Lifelong growth.
There's one right life path you must find.	There's no single right path; decide well by your own values.	No single path.
Exam stress means you're weak or not coping.	Stress at big moments is normal; tools and support help.	Exam stress.
Failing at something makes you a failure.	Failure is an event to learn from, not who you are.	Resilience.
Asking for help means you've failed at adulting.	Help-seeking is a lifelong strength; capable adults lean on people too.	Help-seeking.
Once you turn 18 you stop needing support.	Needing people never expires; help-seeking continues for life.	Lifelong support.
People skills are something you're just born with.	Communication, boundaries and conflict skills are all learnable.	Learnable skills.
A good decision is one that turns out perfectly.	A good decision is made well, with the facts and values you had.	Process over outcome.

The micro-loop.

1. **Situation.** Sam (grown) opens with a real-life decision, transition, or people-situation.
2. **Draw on the toolkit.** The young person uses self-knowledge and the toolkit to decide or act.
3. **See the future.** The life-sim's branching futures make the choice's consequences visible.
4. **The flip.** UN clears a life-myth ("asking for help means you've failed"); RE writes the truth.
5. **Support & help.** Building a support network; serious distress routes warmly to real help.
6. **Sticker.** The Life-Ready badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **life-sim's branching futures** and the **"toolkit assembled"** payoff. It's the culmination of the feelings thread (Feelings Friends → Heart Smart → Mind Matters → Bounce → Life Ready), grows from Bounce (g39), draws on Crossroads (g16), and lands just before the Decoded finale (g36) and the Chapter 5 capstone.

Mature, honest, never therapy.

- **Healthy strategies only.** Stress and transition tools are safe and constructive, never pain, shock or self-destructive coping.
- **Pressure-free decisions.** No single 'right' life path is pushed; the skill is deciding by one's own values, within safety and law.
- **Routes distress to help.** Serious or persistent distress (incl. exam-related) is met with warmth and a clear route to support, not assessment questions.
- **Not therapy.** It builds life skills and signposts; it never claims to treat, and points serious struggles toward professional help.
- **Distress-aware Q&A.** Anonymous questions are vetted; crisis is routed urgently to help.
- **India-tuned.** Speaks to board-exam pressure, family/career expectations and the college/work transition; aligns with Manodarpan and career guidance.
- **Access & privacy.** Audio, offline, low-end build; the values map, life plan and Q&A are on-device, never tied to an identity (DPDP-aligned).

Handle the big stuff & your support map (India). Name the stress · use a healthy strategy · break it down · lean on your people · ask for help early. Your support map: friends · family · a mentor or teacher · a counsellor / professional · helplines, Tele-MANAS 14416 and KIRAN 1800-599-0019, and Manodarpan for student wellbeing. Help-seeking is a lifelong strength, not a failure.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. life-ready** — `node.game === GameDone` key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema**. type + typed payload; the **branch** decide-and-handle move leads, with **reflect** for self-knowledge.
- **Healthy strategies only**. Coping content is constructive, server-side enforced; never pain-based or self-destructive; serious distress routes to help.
- **Fact-checked content**. The India student-wellbeing services (Manodarpan, Tele-MANAS 14416, KIRAN) and exam-stress data verified; flag any service/data edit for re-verification.
- **Scorecard-gated**. Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 31%, 0% binary, 29 autonomy, 12 UN→RE, 5 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run `score_gdd.py` on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook**. Serious distress routes via the shared "get help" component (Tele-MANAS 14416 / KIRAN / Manodarpan / trusted adult); not therapy.
- **Tracked**. `build_gate.py` finalize advances g42 to v2 PASS only after order, read, score, audit and artifact gates pass.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): healthy strategies only; pressure-free decisions; not therapy; routes distress to help; help-seeking as strength; consolidates the Life-Skills Toolkit; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Self-knowledge anchors good decisions.** Because every good adult choice rests on knowing your own values and strengths, starting with reflective self-knowledge (no 'right' answers) is what makes the decision method genuinely yours.
- **Healthy coping, honestly taught.** Since late-adolescent transitions are genuinely hard and exam stress is near-universal, teaching healthy strategies without minimising the strain, and routing real distress to help, is the safe, effective approach.
- **Help-seeking is the keystone.** Because the biggest protective factor is not doing it alone, normalising a lifelong support network and help-seeking as a strength is the single most important message to send a young person into adulthood with.

Sources: UNESCO ITGSE Key Concept 5 (Skills for Health & Wellbeing); WHO on life skills and adolescent mental health (decision-making, coping, help-seeking); Government of India MoE Manodarpan (student wellbeing, exam stress, transitions) and the NCERT Manodarpan survey (~81% of students cite exams/schoolwork as a stressor); Tele-MANAS 14416 and KIRAN 1800-599-0019. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 42 games now v2. Next by order: Decoded (g36), the Chapter 5 finale, then the c5 capstone.